

T H U R S D A Y

IT'S NOT
FAIR

Screwdriver

SCRIPTURE TEXT:

**“You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart,
with all your soul, and with all your strength.”**

Deuteronomy 6: 5 (NKJV)



LESSON OBJECTIVE

Children, teens, and young adults, have a responsibility too! Do you sometimes feel like life doesn't seem fair (and many times it simply is not fair) or you don't understand the rules your parents have set? Perhaps you question some of the decisions your parents make on your behalf, or you are disappointed in the way they speak to you sometimes.

Stop and think about all the good things your parents do for you like providing for your needs— food, shelter, clothing, education, and many extras, then thank God for them and ask God to help you be an obedient child, regardless of your age. Ask God to forgive your parents for the times they don't get it right and ask God to help you turn your heart toward your mother, father, or guardian. If your parent has not been responsible or godly, pray to God and ask Him to perform a miracle in your home, to change your parents, or change your situation.

“Children, obey your parents in the Lord, for this is right.” Ephesians 6:1



Turning the hearts of the children to the parents.

Read Malachi 4:5-6

The story of Elijah on Mt. Carmel was epic! Some of the most powerful parts of the story are the persevering prayers of Elijah. Amazing things happened when Elijah prayed. Elijah prayed that God would restore the broken altar and save the people. The ***Elijah message*** is just as relevant in our homes today. Parents, we need to pray for an outpouring of the Holy Spirit earnestly and diligently in our homes that will encourage heart-turning—repentance and forgiveness between parents and children and between family members.

While parents may not always get it right, God expects parents to guide, teach and discipline their children. The word discipline comes from the word disciple. In essence, when we discipline our children, we are discipling them, not punishing them, but rather correcting and guiding them. Parents are to disciple their children in the ways of God in the hope they will ultimately choose Christ as their Lord and Savior. ***“The home should be to the children the most attractive place in the world...Children have sensitive natures. They are easily pleased, and easily made unhappy. By gentle discipline, in loving words and acts, mothers [parents] may bind their children to their hearts.”*** The Adventist Home, p. 21

It's easy as adults to forget how powerless children can feel and the pressure they feel daily to cooperate and comply with the many demands thrown at them all day. ***“Clean up your room or you won't get to play video games.” “Eat your veggies or you will not get dessert.” “You are not leaving this house looking like that!”*** And when all else fails, ***“Because I said so!”*** Imagine how you would feel if you were spoken to like

that every day! It is necessary for parents to set appropriate boundaries with children, however, it's equally as important for children to be taught how to make healthy choices. God wants us to follow Him, but He gives every individual the power to choose. Children that are given choices, are better prepared to act responsibly, especially when confronted with choices that go against their family's values. Being able to make decisions in various aspects of their lives also helps children to develop healthier self-esteem and belief that they matter to others, especially their parents and to God.

It takes time and patience to allow your child to have choices. But remember, a little time now, can have important long-term benefits. The opposite is true, not taking the time or having patience will have significant long-term consequences. Giving your child choices doesn't mean you grant every wish or desire, but even a three-year-old can be given the choice to wear green pants or black pants or take a nap on the floor or on the bed. The idea is that pants need to be worn, but does it matter what color they are if it's not a school uniform? Your child needs to take a nap, does it have to be on the bed?

Commit to helping your child feel that he or she matters to you and to God and that there will be a major heart-turning in your home during this week and beyond.

PRAYER

Dear God, we are very grateful You always give us choices. We thank You for showing us daily how special we are in Your eyes and that we matter to You. You alone deserve our honor and praise. We want to follow You always and choose You again and again. In Jesus' name, amen.



APPLY IT & LIVE IT



BIBLE CHALLENGE

Recite the memory text together as a family. Look for other texts in the Bible that have a similar promise or command.



FAMILY TALK

- Do you believe God has a special purpose and mission for your family?
- Do you feel that God has performed special blessings or miracles for your family now or in the generations before? Share these stories with each other and with others who might be encouraged by hearing your family story.
- Why is heart-turning so important in understanding God's desire to have a covenant with each of us and with our family?



REBUILDING THE FAMILY ALTAR

Fill a bag with balls that are used for different sports. Get your children to identify the different kinds of balls and find out what game is their favorite.

Then ask them about the rules! Do they know the rules of the game? Ask them what happens when a rule is broken.

Sometimes, a player will be thrown out of the game! Or the entire team might get a penalty of some kind just because one person didn't play by the rules.

God has rules, too. Talk about what these rules might be. And when we break them, it's not good. God is not happy. We are not happy (because we feel bad inside) and others are not happy -- like mom or dad, or our teachers or friends. But the

good news is that when we break God's rules, we are not out of the game! There is still hope. God loves us. That is what the Bible says. God wants to give us as many opportunities as possible to stay in the Game. He wants to save us in His Kingdom.

